

We talked mostly about still photography so far but you can't ignore video recording. From the humble days of the Nokia 3650 to the Galaxy Note 3 recording in 4K resolution, video recording on phones has also come



Nokia 3650

a long way. In the early days, Nokia was the first to push video recording on smartphones. Still for a fairly long time, video recording was firmly in the standard definition phase, even though still cameras were reaching 12 megapixel resolution.

This is when Samsung launched the Omnia HD, which was the first phone to have 720p or high definition video recording. The next step came two years later in the form of the LG Optimus 2x, which was the first phone to have 1080p or Full HD video recording. And then it was the Samsung Galaxy Note 3, which reached the 4K mark four years later.

The growth in video recording resolution did not follow the same quick pace of growth as still recording, simply because it requires a lot more processing power to increase video recording resolution than that for still images. This is why even today we don't have a lot of professional 4K cameras and most of them max out at 1080p. Which is why the mere presence of 4K on phones today is such a big deal and a testament to how far we have come.

So why the long history lesson? It's because it is necessary to look back to our not so distant past and see what we had back then to truly appreciate what we have today. From the days of the Nokia 7650 mentioned at the beginning of this chapter, a lot has changed. We now have better quality image sensors that can be smaller and still be more sensitive to light, capturing images that can beat point and shoot cameras. The optics have come a long way and we even have professional grade lenses on our phones now. The camera software has improved leaps and bounds and now offers a wealth of options to adjust various parameters of an image before shooting so you have full control even if you're not on a proper camera. And a ton of sharing options means you have more ways than you need to put those great images you captured to use.